

From Modernization to AI-Native Banking

Speaker Discussion Themes and Questions

Date	Monday, 14 September 2026
Time	10:00 AM to 11:30 AM
Location	Meeting Room Hospitality Suite 16, Hall 2, Level 1
Venue	Riyadh Exhibition & Convention Center, Malham, Saudi Arabia

Purpose

These themes and questions are intended to guide an open, forward-looking conversation. They are discussion prompts and do not require prepared or scripted responses.

THEME 1: MOVING BEYOND AI EXPERIMENTATION TO ENTERPRISE IMPACT

Context: *Most financial institutions have no shortage of AI pilots. The challenge is turning isolated successes into measurable business outcomes at scale.*

Discussion questions

- Many institutions have invested heavily in AI over the past 24 months. Where are you seeing genuine business value emerge, and where do you think expectations have exceeded reality?
- What are the biggest organisational or operational barriers preventing AI initiatives from moving from pilot phase into production at scale?
- Looking back at your own journey, what would you do differently if you were starting your AI transformation programme today?
- How should leaders balance the pressure to move quickly with the need to build sustainable long-term capabilities?

THEME 2: MODERNISATION AS A BUSINESS CHALLENGE, NOT A TECHNOLOGY CHALLENGE

Context: *Legacy platforms are often discussed as technology issues, but many transformation programmes fail because of organisational complexity, competing priorities and change management challenges.*

Discussion questions

- In your experience, what makes modernisation programmes stall or lose momentum even when there is strong executive support?
- How do you determine which legacy constraints genuinely need to be addressed versus those that can be worked around?
- What are the most common mistakes institutions make when trying to modernise while continuing to support day-to-day operations?
- How do you keep business stakeholders engaged and aligned during multi-year transformation programmes where benefits may not be immediate?

THEME 3: BUILDING THE FOUNDATIONS FOR AI AT SCALE

Context: *Many institutions recognise that AI success depends less on models and more on data quality, architecture, governance and operational readiness.*

Discussion questions

- What foundational capabilities have proven most important in enabling AI adoption across your organisation?
- Where are institutions still underestimating the effort required to prepare data, processes and governance for large-scale AI deployment?
- How do you prioritise investments between customer-facing innovation and foundational capabilities that may be less visible but equally critical?
- What lessons have you learned about creating the right balance between innovation and governance?

THEME 4: MANAGING RISK, TRUST AND REGULATION IN AN AI-DRIVEN FUTURE

Context: *As AI becomes embedded into critical decision making, institutions must navigate increasing scrutiny from regulators, customers and boards.*

Discussion questions

- What concerns are senior executives and boards raising most frequently around AI adoption today?
- How do you build trust in AI-generated decisions when transparency and explainability remain ongoing challenges?
- Where do you see the greatest regulatory uncertainty, and how is that influencing investment and deployment decisions?
- What governance approaches have proven effective without slowing innovation to the point where value is lost?

THEME 5: WHERE WILL FUTURE GROWTH COME FROM?

Context: *Modernisation is ultimately about enabling growth, improving customer outcomes and creating new business opportunities rather than simply reducing costs.*

Discussion questions

- Looking ahead three to five years, where do you believe the greatest growth opportunities will come from for banks and insurers?
- How do you see AI changing customer expectations and competitive differentiation across financial services?
- Which emerging capabilities or business models do you believe are currently receiving too little attention from industry leaders?
- If we were having this conversation in 2030, what do you think would be the defining characteristics of a truly AI-native financial institution?

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